

## 032. Chapter 3 Verses 19-21

*Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda*

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### VERSE 3.19

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तस्मादसक्तः सततं कार्यं कर्म समाचर ।  
असक्तो ह्याचरन्कर्म परमाप्नोति पूरुषः ॥ 19 ॥

tasmādasaktaḥ satataṁ  
kāryaṁ karma samācara |  
asakto hyācarankarma  
paramāpnoti pūruṣaḥ ||

tasmāt – therefore; asaktaḥ – unattached; satatam – constantly; kāryam – which ought to be done; karma – action; samācara – perform; asaktaḥ – unattached; hi – indeed; ācaran – performing; karma – action; param – the Supreme; āpnoti – attains; pūruṣaḥ – a man.

**Therefore that work which should be done, do it well always without attachment. He who performs all the prescribed duties in a detached spirit will attain the Supreme.**

### VERSE 3.20

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कर्मणैव हि संसिद्धिमास्थिता जनकादयः ।  
लोकसंग्रहमेवापि सम्पश्यन्कर्तुमर्हसि ॥ 20 ॥

karmaṇaiva hi saṁsiddhim  
āsthitā janakādayaḥ |  
lokasaṅgrahamēvāpi  
sampaśyankartumarhasi ||

karmaṇā – by action; eva – only; hi – indeed; saṁsiddhim – perfection; āsthitāḥ – attained; janaka-ādayaḥ – Janaka and others; loka-saṅgraham – welfare of the world; eva – only; api – also; sampaśyan – having in view; kartum – to perform; arhasi – you should.

**King Janaka and others attained perfection by action. Even having in view the need to show the right path to the masses, you should work.**

### VERSE 3.21

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यद्यदाचरति श्रेष्ठस्तत्तदेवेतरो जनः ।  
स यत्प्रमाणं कुरुते लोकस्तदनुवर्तते ॥ 21 ॥

yadyadācarati śreṣṭhas  
tattadevetaro janaḥ |  
sa yatpramāṇam kurute  
lokastadanuvartate ||

◆ yat yat – whatever; ācarati – does; śreṣṭhaḥ – a great man; ◆ tat tat – that very thing; eva – only; itaraḥ – other; janaḥ – people; ◆ saḥ – he; yat – what; pramāṇam – standard/example; kurute – sets; ◆ lokaḥ – the world/people; tat – that; anuvartate – follows.

**What-so-ever a great man does, that other men do; whatever he sets up as the standard, that the world follows.**